

AYUSHMAN BHARAT: IMPACT OF 'DOUBLE-ENGINE' GOVT

After inception, the Mohan Majhi government undertook a significant rebranding of many welfare schemes in June last year. While these changes primarily involved renaming and restructuring state-level programs, there was also a notable integration of certain Central government schemes into the state's framework. Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY) or simply 'Ayushman Bharat' is the most prominent among them.

Previously, Odisha had its own health insurance scheme, the Biju Swasthya Kalyan Yojana (BSKY). Under the Majhi administration, BSKY was rebranded as the Gopabandhu Jana Arogya Yojana and integrated with the Centre's Ayushman Bharat scheme, initially touted as "Modi Care" on the lines of "Obama Care". This convergence aims to provide cashless treatment facilities at both private and government hospitals across the state.

11.25% QUOTA FOR SEBC STUDENTS

In a landmark decision, the Mohan Majhi government has introduced an 11.25 per cent reservation for students from the socially and economically backward classes (SEBC) in state-owned and state-funded higher education institutions. Ths is set to come into effect from the academic year 2025-26, taking the total ratio of quota in education to 50 per cent in the state.

The new reservation is part of a broader framework that includes 22.5 per cent for Scheduled Tribes (ST), 16.25 per cent for Scheduled Castes (SC), 5 per cent for persons with disabilities (PwD) and 1 per cent for ex-servicemen.

The initiative seeks to promote access, equity and inclusion, increase the Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) and enhance opportunities for marginalised and disadvantaged communities in Odisha in line with the National Education Policy 2020. This aligns with the national goal of increasing educational opportunities for underrepresented groups.

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

Odisha can position itself as an IT and startup hub by setting up IT parks, innovation hubs and incubation centres in cities like Bhubaneswar and Rourkela as well as by encouraging local entrepreneurs through funding and mentorship programs.

ENVIRONMENTAL SUSTAINABILITY

Odisha is prone to natural disasters like cyclonic storms and floods. Hence, 'Vikasit Odisha' emphasises disaster-resilient infrastructure, renewable energy initiatives like solar and wind energy projects as well as afforestation and conservation of biodiversity-rich ecosystems like Chilika, Simlipal and Bhitarkanika.

CHALLENGES & OPPORTUNITIES

On its way to achieving this feat, Odisha faces many arduous challenges like poverty alleviation, managing frequent natural disasters and balancing industrial growth with environmental sustainability. But, at the same time, the state is also a land opportunities. 'Vikasit Odisha' envisages to leverage the state's strategic location on the eastern coast, utilise its rich cultural heritage to promote tourism and attract investments through policy reforms and incentives.

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'Vikasit Odisha' is more than just a developmental blueprint. It is a call to action for every Odia to participate in the transformation of their state. By building on its strengths and addressing its challenges, Odisha can emerge as a model state that offers its people a high quality of life while contributing significantly to the nation's progress.

FACTSHEET

ELECTRONICS & IT

- **AI Policy:** Cabinet nod to the state's Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy to facilitate use of technology in key sectors like education, healthcare, agriculture, disaster management and governance, ensuring every citizen benefits from AI
- **Advancing AI:** A state-level workshop on "Advancing AI in Odisha" was organised, bringing together thought leaders, policymakers and AI experts to explore strategies for leveraging AI to drive digital transformation and enhance governance across Odisha
- **Semiconductor unit:** The ground-breaking ceremony held for India's first Silicon Carbide manufacturing facility to be set up by RIR Power Electronics Ltd
- **Job creation:** Investment intents worth Rs 20,000 crore with employment potential of 49,000 received at Utkarsh Odisha-Make in Odisha conclave held early this year
- **Odisha One Portal:** For one-stop access to public services, this common front-end interface has been developed to make it convenient for citizens to access G2C services